Holding Pattern

S&P 500 +0.12% to fresh high. NVDA +4.00% to a record. AMD −3.79% on ARK's $75M trim. VIX compressed to 18.02 ahead of FOMC, five Mag7 prints, GDP, and PCE.

THE SESSION

The tape drifted into the catalyst stack rather than priced it. The S&P 500 added 0.12% to 7,173.66, a fresh high, while the Nasdaq tacked on 0.20% to 24,887.10 and the Dow eased 0.13% to 49,167.80. The VIX compressed 3.69% to 18.02 — a striking contraction with the FOMC convening tomorrow, four Mag7 hyperscalers reporting Wednesday after close, Apple Thursday, and Q1 GDP plus March PCE both arriving Thursday at 8:30. Implied moves on the Wednesday cohort sit double-digit per Benzinga options data; the realized tape said wait.

Underneath that quiet surface, leadership narrowed sharply. NVDA closed at $216.61, up 4.00%, extending the record run that pushed the company past $5 trillion in market value last week. The rest of the IOWN semiconductor sleeve went the other way: AMD −3.79% on the Cathie Wood ARK $75M trim disclosed Friday after a near-70% one-month run, MRVL −3.71%, NXPI −2.94% into Tuesday's print, KEYS −1.82%, CRDO −7.45% giving back the bulk of Friday's rally, and LRCX −3.10% in the dividend sleeve. TEL's −2.40% extended the connector-cohort pullback. The pattern is profit-taking compression after Friday's Intel-driven surge, not a thesis change — every name on that list still carries meaningful April gains.

Treasury auctions printed firm on the duration end. The 2-year cleared at 3.812% versus 3.936% prior, the 5-year at 3.955% versus 3.98% — a duration bid into Powell's penultimate FOMC press conference. The CME FedWatch path implies a 99.5% hold tomorrow per Motley Fool coverage; the market-moving content sits in the dot-plot framing of the energy-inflation pass-through and any signal on the Powell-to-Warsh succession mechanics now that the DOJ probe has cleared. Brent stayed firm near $107 with WTI at roughly $96 after Iran reaffirmed over the weekend that Hormuz transit will not return to its prior state, keeping the energy-inflation bid intact ahead of Thursday's PCE.

IOWN Tactical: The dispersion between NVDA's record close and the rest of the chip sleeve is the morning brief's thesis playing out in real time — positioning compressed against the catalyst stack, with hyperscaler capex guidance Wednesday the binary that resolves it.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

NVDA +4.00% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $216.61 at a record on continued AI buildout momentum. Per CNN reporting, JPMorgan flagged that the run may face limits going forward, while LiveRamp announced a Spectrum-X integration delivering 15x faster AI speeds. The catch-up trade Yahoo flagged Friday delivered, and the data-center read-through carries the entire sleeve's narrative into Wednesday's Mag7 capex prints.

SSNC +1.99% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $68.63 recovering Friday's 3.95% pullback. Quality dividend bid into the FOMC.

ABT +1.83% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $92.80 on defensive bid as the tape compressed against the catalyst stack. Healthcare and consumer staples drew quiet inflows.

FTNT +1.58% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $85.67. Cybersecurity sleeve held up as enterprise software diverged — the lone meaningful Growth winner outside NVDA.

VLO +1.02% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $238.25 with Brent holding near $107 after Iran reaffirmed Hormuz restrictions over the weekend. Refining margins remain elevated relative to pre-conflict baselines per Morgan Stanley research.

DECLINERS

CRDO –7.45% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $180.50 giving back the bulk of Friday's 5.12% rally as the chip sleeve compressed ex-NVDA. No direct catalyst — positioning unwind ahead of Wednesday's hyperscaler capex prints.

AMD –3.79% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $334.63 after Cathie Wood's ARK Invest disclosed selling 215,643 shares Friday at $347.81 across five ETFs, valued at roughly $75M. Per GuruFocus and TheStreet, the sale followed a near-70% one-month run; ARK simultaneously rotated $74M into Amazon ahead of Wednesday's print. The trim is profit-taking, not thesis change — AMD remains ARK's third-largest ARKK holding at roughly $416M. AMD reports May 5.

MRVL –3.71% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $158.21 on continued chip-cohort profit-taking. Yahoo cited 'Iran war fears and big tech earnings' framing for the broader chip wipeout.

LRCX –3.10% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Closed $259.47 as semiconductor capital equipment compressed alongside the broader chip cohort. ChartMill flagged it among the session's S&P 500 losers.

NXPI –2.94% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Closed $236.87 ahead of Tuesday morning's Q1 print. Implied move ranges are elevated; the auto/industrial end-market read carries the dividend sleeve's tone into Wednesday.

HOLDINGS NEWS

QCOM holds Friday's pop into Wednesday's print. Closed $150.26 (+0.95%), retaining the 11.12% Friday rally driven by AI-edge optionality positioning. The Q2 FY26 report Wednesday after close targets revenues of $10.2–11B and GAAP EPS of $1.69–1.89 per company guidance. Polymarket prices a 93% probability of consensus beat per 24/7 Wall St; implied straddle move is approximately 7.4%. Data-center accelerator commentary and on-device AI handset attach metrics are the two re-rate vectors.

NXPI Tuesday morning, OKE Wednesday, PCAR Tuesday morning. The IOWN earnings sequence is dense across the week. NXPI's industrial/auto end-market commentary will set tone for the chip-cohort capex narrative. PCAR carries the freight-cycle read-through; OKE the energy-infrastructure read-through.

AMD ARK trim disclosed. Cathie Wood's ARK Invest sold 215,643 AMD shares Friday valued at roughly $75M across ARKK and four sister funds, per Investing.com and GuruFocus disclosures. Simultaneously bought 280,450 Amazon shares ahead of Wednesday's print and 4.02M shares of nuclear startup X-Energy on its IPO debut. AMD remains ARKK's third-largest holding at approximately $416M; AMD reports Q1 May 5.

NVDA crosses $5T market cap milestone. Per CNBC, NVDA became the first publicly traded company to hit $5 trillion in market capitalization Friday and held the level through today's session at $216.61. Morningstar fair value sits at $672 (post-split adjusted); the stock continues to trade well above analyst-modeled intrinsic value as the AI infrastructure thesis compounds.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✗ TRAIL

+0.05%

vs. DVY +0.33% | SPY +0.17%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✗ TRAIL

–1.15%

vs. IUSG +0.51%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +11.06% vs DVY +7.98% / SPY +4.88%
Growth +5.48% vs IUSG +6.26%